

Jeffreys Bay

Location Eastern Cape province, South Africa

One of the best surfing locations in the world, Jeffreys Bay has ideal wave conditions, which are attributed to a combination of swell size, direction, and frequency; wind direction; tides; and the shape of the seabed. Just offshore, the warm Agulhas Current passes west before turning back on itself at the eastern

edge of the Agulhas Bank, where it meets cold water from the west. Here, upwelling has produced a huge marine ecosystem.

Cape Point

Location Western Cape province, South Africa

This headland lies just east of the Cape of Good Hope and forms the western entrance to False Bay.

Hard quartz sandstones form cliffs that rise more than 660 ft (200 m) from the sea. There are two lighthouses, although only one is operational. The headland is part of the Cape Floral Region, an area with an extraordinary variety of plants that grow nowhere else in the world. Offshore are the cold, nutrient-rich waters of the Benguela Current, which fuel high rates of phytoplankton growth and sustain a very productive marine ecosystem.

Other coasts, islands, and reefs in Africa

- **Los Gigantes Cliffs** » p.198
- **The Red Sea Coast** » p.199
- **The Seychelles** » p.314

Asia

The Yaeyama Islands

Location East China Sea, southwest of Okinawa, Japan

This archipelago of 32 islands and numerous islets has volcanic origins. More than 90 percent of Iriomote, the largest island, is covered by tropical rain forest, with mangroves around the coast. It is home to the critically endangered and endemic Iriomote cat. Ishigaki is the second biggest island. Its offshore coral reefs provide prime habitat for dolphins, sea turtles, manta rays, and whale sharks, although dugongs are now virtually extinct here.

